

Chapter 34-2

Returning to her hotel room, Yin Lingzhu looked at the script in her hands and felt afraid.

She had wasted an entire afternoon and accomplished nothing.

What was she going to do when she got to the film crew tomorrow?

Yin Lingzhu sat on the bed and threw herself backward in a self-defeating manner.

The script covered her face, filled with the strong smell of ink.

She was definitely going to get scolded tomorrow. Besides President Yan, there should be other people in the crew who could help, right?

Yin Lingzhu took out her phone and flipped through her contacts one by one.

There were also other veteran actors in the crew, but looking at their chat windows, Yin Lingzhu decided against the idea of approaching them.

Not to mention whether the numbers she had added were actually theirs.

Moreover, these past few days in the crew, she had only focused on memorizing lines and acting, with no time to talk to them at all.

If she disturbed them so rashly, it would probably leave them with a bad impression.

Yin Lingzhu continued scrolling through her contacts.

A message popped up from the top of the screen—it was from Ming Qingyun.

【I heard from the director today that you were resting this afternoon.】

Yin Lingzhu hesitated for a moment, then sent her a message.

【Yes, I didn't act well. The director said my emotions were wrong.】

After Yin Lingzhu replied, she exited the chat window and continued looking through her contacts to see if she could find someone with good acting skills.

【I can help Lingzhu! I have a friend who has been acting for many years. Teaching you would definitely be no problem.】

Looking at the message Ming Qingyun sent, Yin Lingzhu had already typed out a refusal on her keyboard.

Ming Qingyun was really too enthusiastic toward her.

Even though they were college classmates, this kind of attitude made Yin Lingzhu feel something was off.

【Of course, it's not for free~】

Another message from Ming Qingyun popped up. After seeing it, Yin Lingzhu quickly deleted what she had just typed.

【What conditions?】

Yin Lingzhu changed it to these four words. Having conditions was good—mysterious kindness always made people worry.

Yin Lingzhu waited for a long time, so long that she thought Ming Qingyun had gone offline, before finally getting a reply.

【I haven't thought of it yet. I'll tell you when I do.】

Looking at the words on the screen, Yin Lingzhu didn't think for long before typing out "okay."

She didn't have anything worth Ming Qingyun coveting anyway.

【I'll send someone to your room in a bit.】

Seeing this text message, Yin Lingzhu hurriedly typed.

【No need. The crew has a place for rehearsing scenes. We can go there.】

Yin Lingzhu didn't know if Ming Qingyun had seen it—Ming Qingyun's reply never appeared.

There was no "typing" indicator either.

Yin Lingzhu figured the other party hadn't seen it.

Just as Yin Lingzhu was thinking about calling her, there was a knock at the door.

Thinking it was housekeeping, she shouted toward the door, "The room doesn't need cleaning."

There was no more sound from outside the door.

Ming Qingyun faced her friend's resentful gaze without any panic.

"You didn't say anything and just brought me here, and now we can't even get in the door." Her friend looked at her resentfully, her face full of displeasure.

Ming Qingyun came to Yin Lingzhu's room door and took out her phone while knocking.

Only then did she discover the message Yin Lingzhu had sent her.

"I'm investing in your next drama," Ming Qingyun said to her friend lightly, perfectly hitting her friend's weak spot.

Her friend looked at her, "That's what you said. Don't worry, I'll bring out my best skills."

As the two headed toward the film crew, her friend looked at Ming Qingyun, "Do you really like her that much?"

Ming Qingyun looked at the streetlights, "You don't understand."

"She played ambiguous games¹ with you in college—she's totally a scumbag. I really can't figure out how you fell for her."

Her friend and Ming Qingyun had been in the same dormitory. When Ming Qingyun first started her business, the startup capital came from her friend.

She knew Ming Qingyun's past.

Ming Qingyun listened to her words without responding.

While Yin Lingzhu was waiting, Ming Qingyun's message finally arrived.

【Okay! We're heading to the film crew now.】

Yin Lingzhu immediately bounced up from the bed, put on her clothes, and rushed toward the film crew.

It was already dark now, and there wasn't much time left for Yin Lingzhu.

President Yan was just about to look for Yin Lingzhu when she saw Yin Lingzhu's back as she ran out.

She didn't even have time to call out to stop her.

President Yan could only follow behind Yin Lingzhu and watched as she rode away on a shared bicycle.

President Yan looked down at her dress—this was a dress she had specifically picked out.

With a dark expression, she quickly walked to her parking spot and swiftly got into the driver's seat.

She wanted to see who could make Yin Lingzhu go out so late at night.

Fortunately, the car was parked not far from the hotel. When she started the car, she could still see Yin Lingzhu's back.

President Yan followed behind Yin Lingzhu at an extremely slow speed.

After Yin Lingzhu arrived at the film crew, even from a distance, she could see Ming Qingyun waving at her.

Footnotes:

¹ **Ambiguous games (玩暧昧):** This refers to deliberately engaging in flirtatious or romantic behavior without clear commitment—leading someone on with mixed signals. In Chinese dating culture, this is considered manipulative behavior, especially when someone maintains multiple such relationships simultaneously. The friend is essentially calling Yin Lingzhu a "player" who toyed with Ming Qingyun's feelings in college.